Let's continue with the same example: College Student Registration App.

You already have this User Story:

> As a new student, I want to register so that I can create an account.

Now your question is: Why do we need Acceptance Criteria? The User Story already tells us what to build, right?

Correct! The User Story tells us what feature the student wants. But it doesn't tell us all the rules that feature must follow.

Let's understand this in very simple English.

1 Imagine you ask a developer to build registration

You tell the developer:

> “As a new student, I want to register so that I can create an account.”

The developer builds a registration page with three fields:

- Name
- Email
- Password

The developer says, “I have completed registration!”

But now, you test it and discover some problems:

- You can register without entering your name.
- You can enter an invalid email like `abc`.
- You can create an account with a password like `1`.
- You can register twice with the same email.

You ask the developer, “Why did you allow all these things?”

The developer replies, “You only told me to build registration. You never told me these rules!”

> This is the problem Acceptance Criteria helps prevent.

2 What are Acceptance Criteria?

Acceptance Criteria are simply the rules that the feature must satisfy to be considered correct and complete.

For our registration User Story, we can write:

> **USER STORY**
> As a new student, I want to register so that I can create an account.

Acceptance Criteria

Rules for deciding whether registration works correctly

1. The student must enter a name, email, and password.
2. The email must be in a valid email format.
3. The password must meet the agreed password requirements, for example, at least 8 characters.
4. If the email is already registered, the system must show an error instead of creating another account.
5. If all details are valid, the system must create the account and show a success message.

Notice the difference:

- **User Story:** I want to register.
- **Acceptance Criteria:** These are the rules registration must follow.